

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

virus software, update the virus definitions. If you don't have one, install it from the Digit DVD. Also, visit this link and patch your operating system: <http://www.microsoft.com/downloads/details.aspx?FamilyID=e70a0d8b-fe98-493f-ad76-bf673a38b4cf&DisplayLang=en>.

Cannot Read CD-ROM Discs

Q I have a Pentium 4 2.0 GHz processor on a Mercury motherboard with 256 DDR SDRAM and a 52X LG CD-Writer, running Windows XP Professional running. For the past few days, the PC restarts when I insert a CD. But this doesn't happen every time. Is this a Windows problem, or has it got to do with the hardware?

Bhushan Thatte

A If your PC restarts every time you insert CD-ROM disc, then something is wrong with the hardware. Try reading your disks on other CD-ROM drives. If the other drives work fine, then clean your lens using a drive-cleaning disk. If the cleaning disc does not do the trick, it is time you upgrade to a new optical drive. We recommend that you get a CD-Writer and DVD ROM combo-drive.

Monitor Display Goes Red

Q I have a weird problem with my monitor. When I switch on the system, the screen goes red. The red display shows for about 10 minutes, after which the screen returns to normal. My PC is an HCL Beantalk with a 17-inch monitor (HCM780M). How can I solve this problem? My operating system is Windows 98SE.

Nishant Paul

A This isn't a unique problem. It happens during the monsoon, when the humidity is very high. It also occurs if the monitor's colour chip malfunctions. To avoid this problem, keep the monitor covered with dust covers throughout the rainy season. If the problem persists, contact HCL's service centre.

BloodHound Virus Removal

Q My computer is infected with the BloodHound.W32.EP virus. I have Norton AntiVirus installed, but it is unable to repair the c:\windows\system32\tftp8636 file. Norton says that the access to the file is denied. What is this file and will it harm my computer?

Another problem is, when I type in Outlook Express or in Microsoft Word, it automatically adds some words. The icons for cut and paste keep flickering all the time. I simply can't type anything and the cursor moves all over and adds words. Does the BloodHound virus have anything to do with this?

C V Padmanabhan

A Norton AntiVirus definitions prior to May 1, 2002 may detect the presence of a W95.CIH variant as Bloodhound.W32.EP. You

Problem With Memory Slot

Q I have an Intel 815e motherboard with a PIII 866 processor in my system. It has three SDRAM DIMM slots. I have three 128 MB SDRAM sticks running at 133 MHz. When I insert the third module in the third slot, my system stops working.

The BIOS self-test loops and my computer refuses to boot any further. I have verified that all three memory modules swap and work individually. Why is this happening?

P Kumaravel

A It is likely that the problem lies in a faulty memory slot on the motherboard, considering all three memory modules are working individually. Check for dust inside the memory slot and clean it, then install all three modules. If they fail to work, your third memory slot is faulty and your motherboard needs to be repaired.

If the three modules were working together earlier, then the problem is definitely the motherboard's slot. If they were not, then the three 128 MB modules may not be all actually running at 133 MHz. This problem crops up if you mix a 100 MHz module with a 133 MHz module. One of the modules may be a 100 MHz one—try replacing it with a 133 MHz module. You can identify where exactly the problem is by inserting the modules in pairs, in the two slots that work.

Computer Hangs While Online

Q I have a PIII 933 MHz processor with 128 MB RAM, running Windows ME. Whenever I try to go online, an error appears on a blue screen that says, "Windows protection error. You need to restart your computer. System halted." But it doesn't happen when I am offline. What do I do?

Shivkumar

A Your computer is infected with the Blaster worm. The worm shuts down the machine whenever you connect to the Internet, which is why nothing happens when you are offline. To secure your PC, download the Blaster removal tool from <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/FixBlast.exe> and run it on your system to remove the worm. If you have anti-

Illustrations Farzana Cooper



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